

IT Acceptable Use & Security Policy

Version: 1.0

Effective Date: [Insert Date]

Document Owner: IT Department

1. Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to outline the acceptable use of computer equipment, software, and internet access at [Company Name]. This policy is in place to protect the employees and the company from illegal or damaging actions by individuals, either knowingly or unknowingly. Effective security is a team effort involving the participation and support of every employee and affiliate who deals with information and/or information systems.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all employees, contractors, consultants, temporaries, and other workers at [Company Name], including all personnel affiliated with third parties. This policy applies to all equipment that is owned or leased by [Company Name].

3. General Use and Ownership

3.1 Proprietary Information

While [Company Name]'s network administration desires to provide a reasonable level of privacy, users should be aware that the data they create on the corporate systems remains the property of [Company Name]. Employees should have no expectation of privacy regarding data residing on company-owned devices or sent via company email.

3.2 Asset Management

- **Inventory:** All hardware issued (laptops, monitors, peripherals) is tracked in the IT Asset Management system.
- **Return of Assets:** Upon termination of employment or contract, all company-issued hardware must be returned to the IT Department within 48 hours.
- **Modifications:** Employees may not disassemble or physically modify company hardware (e.g., upgrading RAM) without IT authorization.

4. Security and Proprietary Information

4.1 System Access

- **Passwords:** Passwords must be at least 12 characters long, contain a mix of letters, numbers, and special characters, and must be changed every 90 days.
- **MFA:** Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) must be enabled for all cloud services (Google Workspace, AWS, Slack, etc.).
- **Locking Workstations:** Employees must lock their screens (Windows+L or Cmd+Ctrl+Q) whenever they leave their desk, even for a short duration.

4.2 Data Confidentiality

- **Classification:** Data should be handled according to its sensitivity (Public, Internal, Confidential, Restricted).
- **Sharing:** Confidential data must not be shared with unauthorized internal or external parties.
- **Encryption:** Sensitive data transferred to USB drives or portable media must be encrypted.

5. Internet and Email Usage

5.1 Acceptable Use

Internet access is provided to assist employees in the performance of their jobs. Limited, occasional, or incidental use of the internet for personal, non-business purposes is acceptable as long as it does not interfere with the employee's productivity or the company network's health.

5.2 Prohibited Use

The following activities are strictly prohibited:

- Visiting websites containing pornography, hate speech, or illegal activities.
- Downloading pirated software, music, or movies.
- Using company email to send "Spam" or chain letters.
- Opening email attachments from unknown sources (Phishing risk).

6. Software and Intellectual Property

- **Licensing:** Employees must not use any software that lacks a valid license.
- **Unauthorized Installation:** Users may not install software on company devices without prior approval from the IT Department (Shadow IT).
- **Development:** All code, scripts, and documentation developed by employees during work hours or using company resources are the exclusive property of [Company Name].

7. Remote Work and Mobile Devices

7.1 VPN Usage

Employees accessing the company intranet or internal tools from a remote location (e.g., home, coffee shop) must use the approved company VPN.

7.2 Physical Security

When working remotely, employees must ensure company devices are not left unattended in public places (e.g., vehicles, cafes) and are physically secured when not in use.

7.3 Public Wi-Fi

Avoid using open, unsecured public Wi-Fi networks for sensitive work. If necessary, tethering to a mobile hotspot is preferred over public Wi-Fi.

8. Incident Reporting

All security incidents, including lost devices, suspected virus infections, or data breaches, must be reported to the IT Helpdesk (support@[company].com) immediately.

9. Enforcement

Any employee found to have violated this policy may be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

Employee Acknowledgment

I, _____, acknowledge that I have received, read, and understood the **IT Acceptable Use & Security Policy**. I agree to adhere to the guidelines provided and understand that any violation may result in disciplinary action.

Signature: _____

Date: _____
